

Step-by-step reintroduction protocol for suddenly aggressive cats based on Jackson Galaxy methods - with troubleshooting for redirected aggression triggers — Action Checklist

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SECURE AND SEPARATE

- ☐ **Secure and Separate:** Move your cats to opposite ends of your home immediately — when cats are in high-arousal states, every encounter deepens the trauma and extends recovery time.
- ☐ **Secure and Separate:** Close all doors between your cats' zones for a minimum of 72 hours — this is how long it takes for feline neurochemistry to normalize after aggressive episodes.
- ☐ **Secure and Separate:** Block all visual access between zones using a baby gate covered with a blanket if you lack a door — even seeing the other cat keeps arousal levels dangerously high.
- ☐ **Secure and Separate:** Set a timer for 72 hours and commit to no cat-to-cat contact until it expires, regardless of how calm your cats appear during the separation period.

BUILD COMPLETE ZONES

- ☐ **Build Complete Zones:** Equip each separation zone with a dedicated litterbox, food and water stations positioned away from each other, an elevated resting spot, and enclosed hiding spaces.
 - ☐ **Build Complete Zones:** Place cat trees, window perches, or elevated beds in each zone so both cats have access to high ground where they feel protected from perceived threats.
 - ☐ **Build Complete Zones:** Add boxes or enclosed beds to each zone for your cats to retreat into when stressed — these hiding spots are essential for fear-based aggression recovery.
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- **Build Complete Zones:** Position food and water in separate locations within each zone so the less confident cat does not have to pass the other cat's area to eat or drink.

DIAGNOSE AND PLAN

- **Diagnose and Plan:** Identify the type of aggression you're dealing with by using the diagnostic worksheet — redirected aggression requires removing external triggers while status aggression requires resource equalization.
- **Diagnose and Plan:** Confirm whether you are dealing with redirected aggression by checking if an outdoor cat, loud noise, or other unreachable trigger caused your cats' relationship to collapse suddenly.
- **Diagnose and Plan:** Determine which cat is truly the aggressor before finalizing your separation plan — the cat you first saw attacking might actually be the fear-based victim whose response escalated.
- **Diagnose and Plan:** Use the four aggression types framework to predict your recovery timeline — redirected aggression typically takes longer than territorial or status aggression to resolve completely.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.